



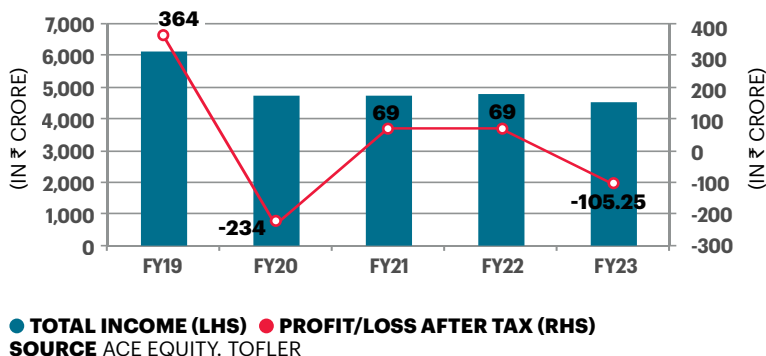
“Nearly all media companies that are active in the direct-to-consumer arena today are now aiming to give consumers a bundled offering of streaming content and other services”

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PROFIT PAIN

Tata Play's net profit dropped significantly in FY23



a bundled offering of streaming content and other services,” the report states, adding that along with boosting sign-ups and reducing churn, bundles allow media companies to improve efficiency in marketing spends and technology investment. Pherwani says, “Going forward, media companies will fully integrate distinct streaming services into one application, creating a true ‘hard’ bundle of content.”

Another challenge that OTT aggregators could address is the subscription fatigue customers face, by allowing users to group multiple subscriptions under

one account sign-on, says Shah. “Consumers can also avail better discounts by purchasing OTT app bundles through an aggregator. Moreover, some recently introduced services such as Tata Play Binge and Airtel XStream have blurred the lines between online video and pay TV, bringing consumers the best of both services,” he adds. In that backdrop, the OTT viewing experience is gradually evolving to resemble the pay TV distribution model, familiar in terms of packaging (bundling of linear TV channels combined with OTT packs), a fusion of content search and discovery, and even

payment experience.

An example is OTTplay—that pivoted last year from being a recommendation and content discovery platform to aggregation. The platform says that it is solving the problem of what to watch through its recommendation engine, along with providing a solution to mitigate subscription fatigue. “People spend over 15 minutes figuring out what to watch, and if they know what they want to watch, they need to figure out which OTT is running it,” says Avinash Mudaliar, Founder of OTTplay. “That’s something we are solving. So the product-market-fit is definitely